

Trishna Tiwari

CSE-DS

Company: IDFC First Bank

Job Profile: Application Engineer

Offer Type: [Internship + Placement]

Internship Stipend: 40k

CTC: 18.10 LPA (Fixed: 14 LPA + Joining Bonus: 2 L + Variable: 2.10 LPA)

Location: Mumbai/Bangalore/Hyderabad

Process Date: PPT(25th July,2025)+ OA(28th July,2025)+Interviews(30th July,2025)

Placement Process:

[List down the rounds that were conducted and any specific information related to it]

1. **[Online Assessment]** [Around 140 candidates][28th July]

The OA consisted of 3 Sections, Logical reasoning(20 minutes), Aptitude(20 minutes) and DSA Questions (40 mins-2 questions). Each question was shut after that allotted time so make sure to read all instructions carefully, so you can attempt all questions. The MCQ's weren't from a specific section, you had to have knowledge about various sections like OOPS, SQL, Basics of development etc, aptitude solving, so there is no separate thing you could do for this section, it's striking in the moment and some basic knowledge that you gathered over the years. No amount of mcq study could guarantee marks in this section, just answer the ones you are sure about and do a guess on others as there was not any negative marking.

Coming to the DSA section- there were 2 DSA questions, both were quite easy, the first was about sorting, the other one I don't remember the exact question but if you are able to solve Leetcode easy-medium section, this will be a cakewalk. I was able to pass all test cases for the first question, but left 3 test cases for the second one which was a case for almost every student, so relatively it was all the same, hardly anyone solved the entire question. So it's about you trying every solution, even brute force, that comes to your mind because you never know that's what everyone did.

2. **[Technical Interview 1]** [45 candidates shortlisted][30th July,2025]

There were 2 interviewers on the panel, so don't get intimidated. The interview began with “Tell me about yourself”, you actually don't need immense prep for this one, just give them a basic overview of what all you did in college years (like DSA, dev, internship (if any), extracurricular activities), I feel that's enough. Now this interview wasn't in any flow, they asked questions from all domains.

1. Basic Questions- Difference between Authentication and Authorization- I answered that followed by which they gave a scenario, there is a case wherein you have three sections, principle's cabin, teacher's cabin and the tpo office, everyone has an admin for that room, and a normal student who doesn't belong to any section needs access to one of these rooms (To clarify the instructions and problem definition wasn't as clear as I have mentioned here but over the discussion you kinda figure out the problem, so you need to DISCUSS with the panel about what you are thinking and if it matches with what they want an answer for, then proceed further, this tells them that you have a good habit of understanding problem statement clearly then moving to solution rather than just jumping without clear understanding). Initially I thought it was about jwt authorization but later I came to the conclusion that it had api keys involved and you had to give a token to everyone who requested it with an expiry time. -There is no certain prep you can do for these types of questions your dev concepts need to be clear which just comes by making projects.

2. OOPS- I was asked about multiple inheritance, the diamond problem I explained along with it, then about Private constructors (Singleton classes) and how they are called (getInstance method), abstraction, C++ vs Java (multiple inheritance, pointers, virtual inheritance).

3. Projects- Asked about how I implemented user authentication using Firebase (to which I gave a detailed explanation), why mongodb (explain abt sql vs no sql) db, why react (virtual dom etc), about use of api in projects.

4. I was asked for the system design of a URL shortener, to which I gave a rough answer (data structure to be used and flow of it).

3. **[Technical Round 2]** [22 candidates][30th July]

In this round with 2 interviewers again, it began with intro, then I was asked about

1. New vs malloc (keyword in java and c++), which is faster, which is better to which I wasn't really correct in all answers, to which the interviewer also said, “its visible, you aren't aware”.
2. Then he asked about destructors and copy constructors, though I had read about them, due to his statement I just forgot about it.

At such points it's really important to keep your calm and look forward to points where you can show him your strengths.

3. Later I was asked a question to check if 4181 belongs to the fibonacci series(not normal fibonacci series printing) to which after some hints i was able to solve.
For such non-traditional questions just keep thinking about different approaches and keep telling the interviewer, till he doesn't tell you to stop.
4. Later it came to some OOPS concepts again which were easy only, they did tell me to write pseudo code so even if your first language isnt java have a basic understanding of how to write classes and instantiate objects, and various keywords,they do tell you to write code.
5. Then came to my projects, and asked about various keywords, like JWT Auth,API's, DB storage, at such points its really important,that you explain them the motive behind each of your project and explain them key parts in detail, they just want to know that it's your original work that you created and with a purpose(is what the interviewer told me as a feedback.)
6. I was given a scenario about a project scaling and was given different scenarios and had to design schema for all of them and also write sql queries.

4. **[HR Round]** [9 candidates][28th July]

Initially it was for an hour, but later, due to time constraints it was for 20-25 minutes. Just be yourself in this interview they want to see the real you and align yourself with the company policies and motives. Also explain how you fit in the company giving real life examples. To be honest I didn't prepare anything for this round, just knew the policy(Always You First) and some motives(like ethics,etc).Take a few minutes to think,it gives you a lot many examples to speak about.

5. **[Fitment/Tech round]** [9 candidates][28th July]

This one started at around 9:30 p.m. , we were at college from 8 a.m , be ready for such long days, and keep your mind prepared to answer equally well in such scenarios.I just left the hr round seconds within i was called for the next round, which was really quick.

This was about my favourite subjects I studied in the curriculum, then I made a mess here by saying soft computing(neural networks) which I had not revised after 4th sem. Then he ended up asking the difference between neural networks and machine learning, which set me a slight back, but took a pause of relief and thought , in basic

terms so i started with ml then recalled some of neural networks and finished the answers. Later he asked for an overview of all projects and this interview ended.

Results were declared next day and

[8 students were offered the job]...

It's really important to study as per the interview experience , that guides you which topics are the most important for that company. Know your resume in and out and everything mentioned on it in detail, because that's the only piece of information they have about you, its ok to have less skills on resume but know everything in detail rather than having more and not knowing some.

Useful Tips:

Hard work is important, but preparing smart for an interview is also really important, reading through interview experiences and prepping accordingly is important .

1. There is a high possibility that even though you are the smartest , you might not end up having a good offer, and that's alright because placement has a huge chunk of your luck being on your side on that day. The day before I had a massive setback after being in college for 12 hours and facing a rejection from Barclays, I never thought I could crack 4 rounds the next day, but just believe in god's plans and in the hard work you have put.
2. Be true to yourself, copying other's projects, or lying in the interview won't land you up anywhere, you cannot always prepare everything for an interview just before it, so the other answers you give is by how much knowledge you have, which doesn't come in a day or two, you need to be consistent from the day you read this.
3. Keep your mind open during interviews, then only you can think of new examples, and answers also the point when the interviewer comes to your strongest point is when you should drag the interview and tell everything you know about it (in minute details, mine were my projects so I explained all of them in deep details.)
4. You need to consistently do DSA, so, in the last 1-2 months you can prepare for the other stuff (I started around 2nd year end and did consistently.)
5. Make your projects with a purpose, and if not at least keep an answer ready which is a real world scenario so u can mention how and why u did the project.

6. Losing hope and feeling demotivated in this period is absolutely normal , but just believe in yourself, keep doing that's the only way, this is just the beginning.Keeping yourself fit in that period is really important that's how you can keep your mind the most active so eat good and sleep well during that period.

Resources

1. DSA- Striver A to Z (giving contests on codechef , codeforces also helped a lot to think quickly, though not compulsory.)
2. Java OOPS-kunal kushwaha playlist
3. Aptitude-Indiabix &
 Aptitude Preparation for Placements #1 Introduction | Why Aptitude Is Important F...
4. SQL,DBMS,OS- GFG, w3 schools,random yt videos for specific concepts.
5. Chatgpt is a really good source to read about and understand your projects and the stack used in it in more depth, and the follow up questions that could be asked.

In case of any further doubts,feel free to reach out.

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